

negative news that it's impossible to become a millionaire in America today. That may be why you picked up this book—you want to see if maybe, just maybe, you have what it takes. If that's you, keep reading, because all of our research and conversations with millionaires have led us to a conclusion that will surprise you and give you hope. Person after person told us strikingly similar stories of starting with little (if any) money, being financially responsible, making basic investments over a long period of time, and achieving millionaire status. You'll see many of their stories throughout this book. As you read, you'll discover that these aren't *special* people; they're *smart* people. And the good news for you is that you are smart—and with time and experience, you can become even smarter.

I told you about Chad earlier. He didn't believe he could ever become a millionaire. He chose to believe the myths and lies, and it was easier for Chad to tell himself he was destined for *financial stress* than to believe he could make his *financial dreams* a reality. That was definitely not the case for Sheila. I was on that same book tour, doing another signing in another city. As I was signing books, I heard a *thud* as a book landed on the table in front of me. I looked up and saw Sheila, a thirty-something single mom with her ten-year-old son in tow. She looked me dead in the eyes and said, "Chris, the cycle ends *here*." I didn't even have to ask her what she meant. I could see it in her eyes; she was letting go of her old beliefs and had chosen to change her financial destiny. She broke several generations of poor-me, why-me, and not-me thinking with that one statement. I'll be honest: I got chills in that moment. I even teared up, because I knew I was witnessing something truly life-changing, not only for her, but for her young son as well. I still get goosebumps thinking about it. Today, Sheila is most likely on her way to millions—because she *believed* she could do it.

As we start this book together, I want you to believe what Sheila believes. I want you to believe what every one of the 10,000 millionaires we've studied believes. I want *their* belief to become *your* belief. We live in one of the greatest countries in the world with the greatest opportunities imaginable. If you believe that millionaire status isn't within your reach, my goal in this book is to show you that it is. And if you believe that you don't have what it takes to get there, I'm going to help you believe that you do! My team has talked to over 10,000 regular men and women just like you who have faced the same doubts and fears throughout their lives just like